

# NYC-Style Bagels

Straight dough · short ~3h bulk → shape → emphasized pan proof → cold hold · boiled & baked

| YIELD     | FLOUR                 | HYDRATION | METHOD             | TOTAL DOUGH |
|-----------|-----------------------|-----------|--------------------|-------------|
| 24 @ 150g | Sir Lancelot<br>14.2% | 60%       | Straight +<br>bulk | ~3,630g     |

## STRAIGHT DOUGH

No poolish — mix it all at once

|                                    |         |               |      |
|------------------------------------|---------|---------------|------|
| Sir Lancelot                       | 2,200 g | Honey (~2.5%) | 55 g |
| Water (60% — cold if warm kitchen) | 1,320 g | ADY (0.5%)    | 11 g |
| Salt (2%)                          | 44 g    |               |      |

The flour's malted barley supplies the enzyme load. **0.5% ADY targets a ~4.5h total room ferment** (~3h bulk + ~1.5h pan proof), **dropped from 0.6%** because the bench rest kick-starts fermentation and the fridge only *slows* it — the dough ripens a bit in the cold, so less yeast keeps the cold-hold honest. Start here; if they still over-ferment in the fridge, go to **0.4%**. If it drags, the granite's colder than figured — nudge up or extend.

## MIX

Two batches — incorporation only, then fold

Mix straight, then divide by weight for the stretch-and-fold. Each batch makes 12 bagels.

### PER MIXING BATCH ×2

|       |         |
|-------|---------|
| Flour | 1,100 g |
| Water | 660 g   |
| Salt  | 22 g    |
| Honey | 27.5 g  |
| ADY   | 5.5 g   |

**Mixer = incorporation only.** At 60% with 14.2% flour the hook can't reach windowpane — gluten's too strong to fully develop in the machine. Run low just until combined, no dry bits, then stop.

**Develop by stretch-and-fold:** after the mix, **bench rest 20–30 min** — it relaxes and hydrates the dough so the first fold actually develops it. Then **2–3 S&F sets ~30 min apart** through the first ~1.5h of bulk; the rests relax it, the folds build the network. **Windowpane is a post-fold check.**

~1,815g dough per batch → 12 bagels @ 150g.

**The consistency lever:** shaping from a **bulk-fermented mass** — not pre-divided pieces — is why pro bagels come out even without a scale. A short bulk organizes the gluten across the whole dough so each piece ropes uniformly. This is the structural reason for the fork.

## TEMP TARGETS

this stage — mix & dough

|                         |      |                 |          |
|-------------------------|------|-----------------|----------|
| Room (dough rests here) | 70°F | Dough after mix | ~68–70°F |
|-------------------------|------|-----------------|----------|

# Execution

| ROOM<br>(BULK+PROOF) | BULK PULL | BOIL BATH  | BAKE  |
|----------------------|-----------|------------|-------|
| 70°F                 | ~50% rise | 212°F roll | 450°F |

## BULK · SHAPE · PROOF · HOLD

- 1 Short bulk, ~3 h:** mix in the morning, then **bench rest 20–30 min** before folding. Bulk on the counter **to ~50% rise**; run **2–3 S&F sets, 30 min apart**, through the first ~1.5 h. The bulk's job is to **organize the gluten**, not the main proof — pull by rise, not clock.
- 2 Divide from the bulk** to 150g. **Gently degas as you pre-round** — press the big bubbles out (trapped gas = uneven ropes). Bench rest **10–15 min**, then rope by **flatten → roll up tight → weld the seam** on un-floured counter (the roll expels gas). Small ~1.5" hole = puffs up, not out.
- 3 Pan proof — THIS is the main proof, ~1–2 h:** rise the shaped bagels on half-sheets at 70°F **to final height**. This is the rise that makes the bagel; weight it here, not in the bulk. Float-test when they look ready.
- 4 Fridge = mostly hold.** Bagels go in **proofed**; they'll **ripen a little in the cold** (it slows, doesn't stop) — the lowered yeast keeps that in check. Cold-hold for flavor + scheduling, boil straight from cold (brief temper).

**Granite note:** cold counter is a heat-sink — it slows the bulk (good, keeps it partial) but unevenly. Bulk in a **bowl** for even temp if you want; the pan proof runs warmer (pan buffers the counter) which is why it finishes the rise.

## BOIL & BAKE

- 1 Float test** straight from cold: surfaces in ~10s → go. Sinks → temper at room temp, retest. **This gates everything.**
- 2 Boil bath:** per ~7 L water add **40 g honey** — **no baking soda** (the alkali thickens and toughens the skin). Gentle rolling boil, never violent.
- 3 Boil 30 sec / side.** Shorter boil = thinner, more tender crust. Seed wet, straight out of the water (everything blend).
- 4 Bake 450°F — 10 min on the boards, 10 min off (clean 50/50, ~20 min):** boiled, seeded bagels go **seed-side-down on the wet bagel boards** (soak them well first — dry burlap scorches and sticks), **steam the first few min**. At **10 min flip them off the boards onto a stone or sheet pan** for the last 10. **No pizza steel** — it dumps too much heat and dries the heel; the boards give an even start and a stone/pan finishes gentler. **Set + even color; ~205–210°F internal confirms done** (thick part of the ring, not the hole).
- 5 Rest 20–30 min** before cutting. Hot crumb reads false-gummy.

## BROWNING MECHANISM

Honey-only bath — golden, not mahogany

Honey deposits a sugar film → **Maillard** fuel for color and flavor. **Baking soda is out:** the alkali browned faster (pretzel chemistry) but set a **thicker, tougher skin** that pulls away from the crumb — the same delamination that sheds everything-seasoning when you cut. Without it the crust bakes **thinner and more tender, but lighter** — **golden, not the deep mahogany that needs barley malt**. Malt is the real color + flavor fix when it's on hand.

## DIAGNOSTICS

|                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dull, soft, over-sprung                       | Under-boiled — skin never set. Add boil time.                                                                                                                                                    |
| Wrinkled, tough, squat, gummy ring under skin | Over-boiled — skin set too hard, strangled spring. Cut boil time.                                                                                                                                |
| Skin right, interior gummy                    | Under-baked. Add 2–3 min; leave boil alone.                                                                                                                                                      |
| Tough bite, tight crumb                       | Under-proofed. Extend the bulk or the shaped room-temp rise; the fridge won't proof it. Float-test before boiling.                                                                               |
| Tough, dried heel                             | Bottom heat too aggressive — <b>skip the pizza steel</b> (it dumps too much heat). Start on the <b>wet boards</b> , then <b>flip onto a stone or pan</b> ; a gentler deck keeps the heel tender. |
| Tough crumb, worse when toasted               | Moisture-starved — <b>60% is the tenderness floor</b> .                                                                                                                                          |